

*The cafe,
Gestures amidst unbroken walls*

Gaze-Interactive Documentary VR

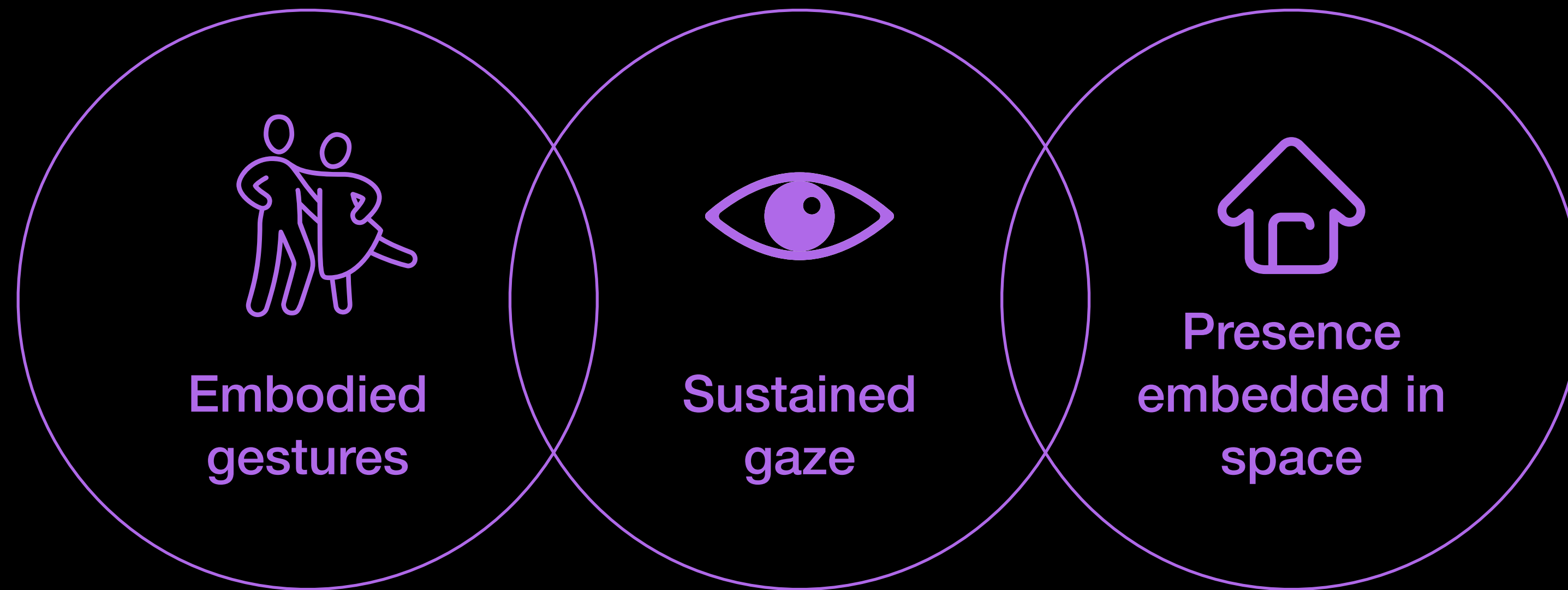
Bonjour, et merci de m'accueillir.

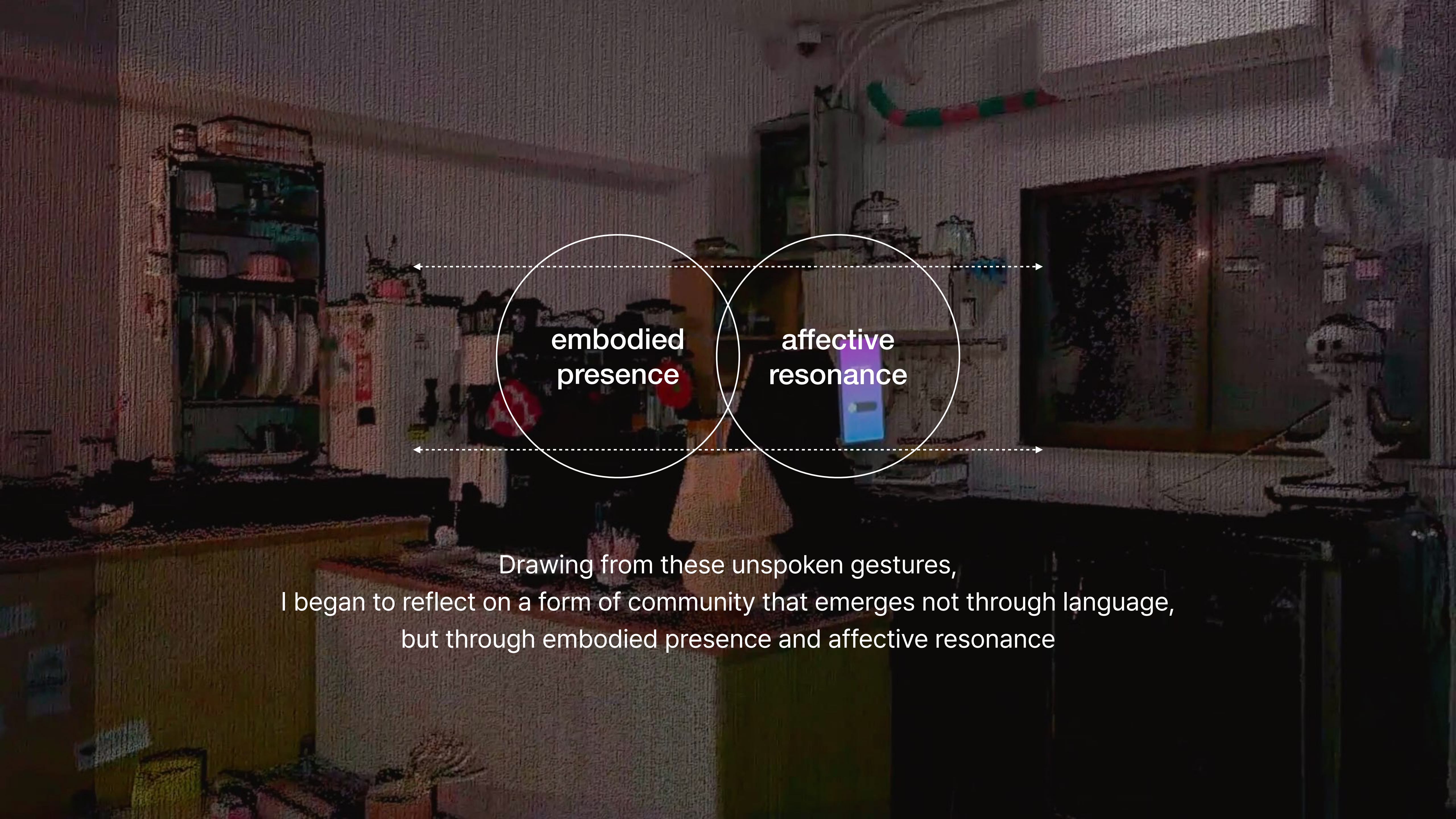
If the gaze serves as a trigger for memory, how might it reshape the embodied perception of spatial experience?



The cafe,
Gestures amidst unbroken walls

"Communication may not originate in verbal language"





embodied
presence

affective
resonance

Drawing from these unspoken gestures,
I began to reflect on a form of community that emerges not through language,
but through embodied presence and affective resonance

INTRODUCTION

The Cafe Gestures Amidst Unbroken Walls



Photograph taken in 2017

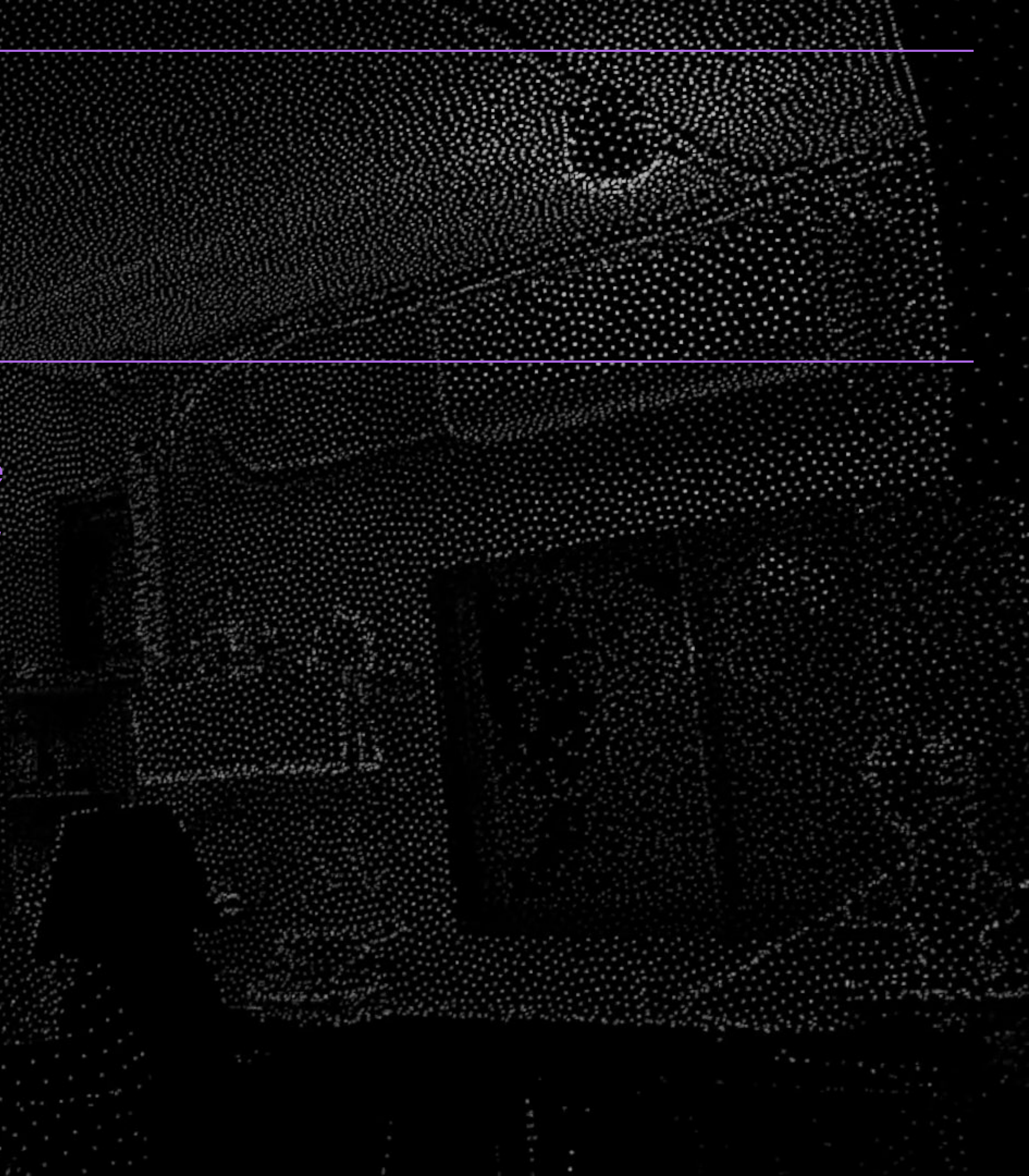
At a key protest site against state-led redevelopment in Jangwi New Town. While some sections have been rebuilt, others remain suspended in unresolved disputes.

LOGLINE

In a soon-to-be-demolished café, viewers unlock dormant memories through their gaze-unveiling hidden narratives embedded in the everyday gestures of a disappearing city.

SYNOPSIS

The Cafe is an interactive VR storytelling experience set inside a neighborhood café awaiting demolition in Jangwi New Town, Seoul. Through gaze-based interaction, viewers engage with ordinary objects-each triggering fragments of memory and layered soundscapes. Subtle gestures and repeated motions performed by former occupants evoke a suspended temporality, blurring the line between presence and absence. As narration and ambient audio guide the journey, a quiet yet politically charged narrative unfolds-shaped by urban erasure, personal memory, and the sensory residues of everyday life.



AUDIENCE EXPERIENCE

In The Cafe, the gaze functions not merely as an interface, but as an extension of the body- a sensory medium through which memory is activated and spatial traces are reassembled.



The experience begins with sound, immersing the viewer in the temporal and spatial atmosphere of the café.



As the viewer navigates the space, ordinary objects-such as a coffee cup, a laptop, and a vibrating phone-respond to their gaze.



Through this gaze-based interaction, fragmented memories and latent narratives gradually unfold.

STORIES

embedded in the objects within the VR space



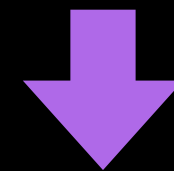
When the viewer gazes at a coffee cup,
a quiet conversation emerges between a longtime resident and an outside investor.



A flickering laptop screen reveals a news article,
drawing the viewer into the perspective of a student documenting protests against redevelopment.



A vibrating phone signals a turning point,
as the café owner receives notice that the building will be demolished within two months.



**In that moment, the ordinary is eclipsed by anxiety, urgency,
and the irreversible weight of impending change.**

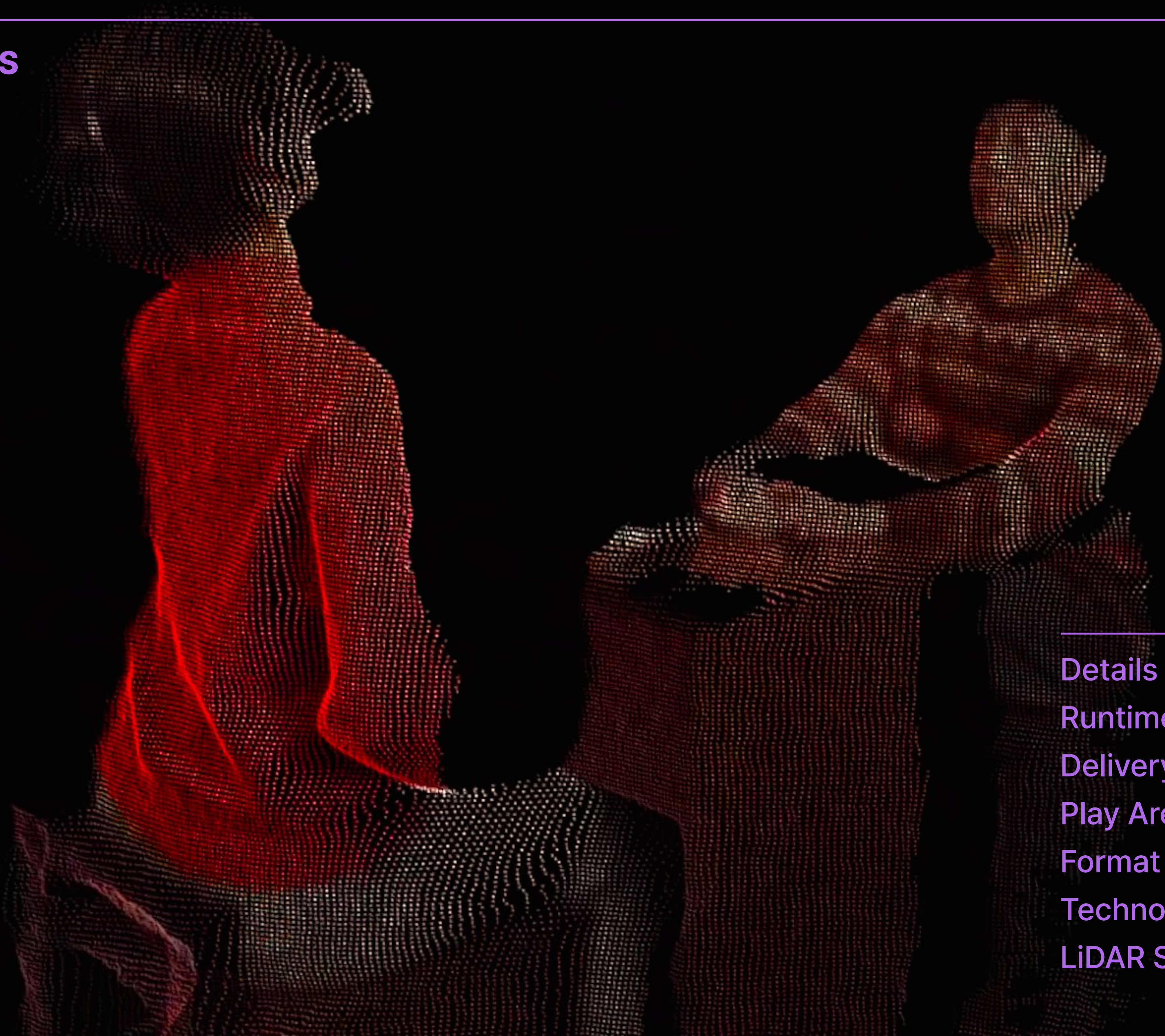
Trailer



Link

<https://youtu.be/Db3oWWlgeC4>

KEY FEATURES

The background of the slide features two wireframe human figures. The figure on the left is colored red and is shown in a standing pose, facing slightly to the right. The figure on the right is colored blue and is shown in a more dynamic, possibly dancing or athletic pose, with one leg raised and arms extended. Both figures are composed of a dense grid of points connected by thin lines, giving them a digital, skeletal appearance. The overall aesthetic is high-tech and futuristic.

Details

Runtime 10min

Delivery VR6Dof, Single Player

Play Area 1m × 2m

Format PCVR

Technologies used Body Tracking,
LiDAR Scanning, Realtime Engine

AUDIENCE REACTION

"A poetic unfolding of space where silence speaks louder than language, and the viewer becomes part of a gesture-based memory."

-Viewer from the 1st test screening

"It felt like being inside a quiet play-where you're no longer an observer, but a presence suspended between lives, movements, and forgotten stories."

- Critic, initial preview

"The ambiguity of the objects, the fragmented narrative, and the subtle tension of gaze-based interaction together evoke a deeply immersive reflection on space, memory, and disappearance."

- Media theorist, VR critic

"The Cafe opens up a theater of nonverbal presence. Through gestures and ambient sound, it renders urban displacement as a sensory experience rather than a spectacle."

- Curatorial feedback

Affective Traces of Jangchungdan **The Unseen Bodies' Oration**

Affective Traces of Jangchungdan is a VR-based immersive experience that reimagines the affective and political residues of Jangchungdan, a historically charged site of mass gatherings and political speeches in modern Korean history. Rather than reconstructing events visually, the work translates bodily gestures, sonic vibrations, and spatial resonance into a sensorial encounter with memory. As the viewer moves through the virtual space, their physical gestures activate unseen traces of past crowds and voices—rendering the body not as a passive observer, but as an agent of performative engagement. Through the interplay of affect, movement, and spatial transformation, the project explores how embodied interaction within VR can evoke the lingering tensions between history, place, and collective memory.

ABOUT THE DIRECTOR



Do-Hyeon Lee is a media artist and researcher based in Seoul. Her work investigates embodied interaction, performativity in extended reality (XR), and the limits of human-centered communication systems.

By incorporating technologies such as LiDAR scanning, body tracking, and real-time engines, she explores post-linguistic modes of expression and the affective dimensions of digital presence. She has participated in various exhibitions and research-driven media art programs both in Korea and internationally.

Award & Grant

2025 ChunMan Art for Young, ChunMan Scholarship Foundation, KR
2024 Super Testbed, Ministry of Culture·Sports and Tourism · Arts Management Support Center · Art Korea Lab, KR
2022 Future Artist Award, Canon Korea · Park Gunhee Foundation, KR
2020 Content Impact, Korea Creative Content Agency, KR

PORTFOLIO HIGHLIGHTS

2024



Voices and Traces

2024



Too obvious to be
defined as Fictional

2023



Manual

2022



Constellation Book

2022



Motion Sensor &
Gesture

2021



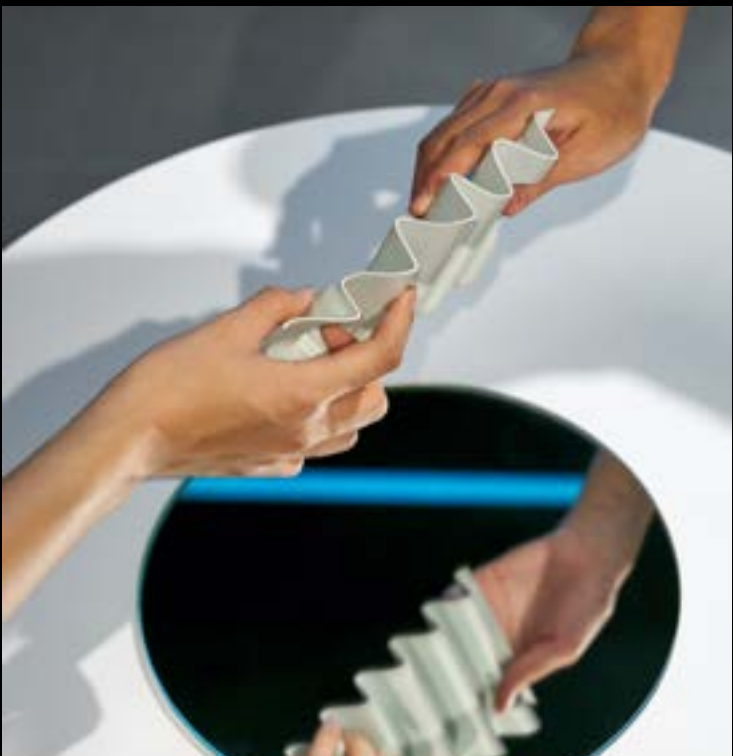
This is not a
Performance, but

2020



Extended
Phenotype 1.0.

2020



Extended
Phenotype 2.0.

2019



A'

2018



Untitled

NOTABLE WORKS



〈Too Obvious to be defined as Fictional〉 (2024)

Visualizes AI's decision-making as a non-human subject with its own logic-challenging anthropocentrism by revealing the epistemological contradictions embedded in human-AI comparisons.

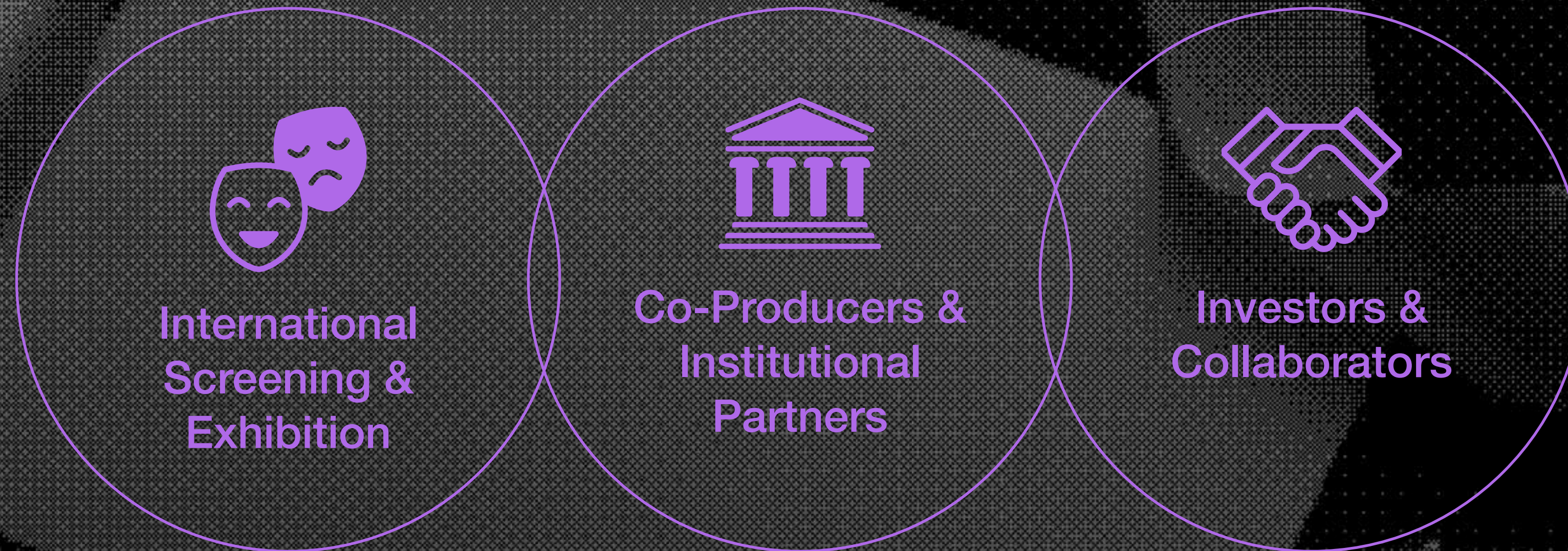
NOTABLE WORKS



《This is not a Performance, but》 Series (2021)

Captures obsessive and unconscious gestures to reveal hidden social codes-unveiling how bodily forms reflect newly constructed norms in our digitized lives.

Invitation to Partners and Presenters



Open to partnerships across media, curating, and exhibition-
with those working at the intersection of technology, embodied
aesthetics, and socio-political discourse-to further develop and circulate
immersive, experience-led works.

The cafe, Gestures amidst unbroken walls

Activate narrative and spatial memory
-through the embodied gaze.

Not through representation,
but through embodied experience and affect.

A reframing of sensorial cognition and shared presence.



Instagram

Instagram @dohyeonlee.official
E-Mail dohyeonlee.official@gmail.com



Notion